Chronology — Year-Wise Major Events (Medieval India)

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

Early medieval kingdoms | Arab & Turkish invasions | Delhi Sultanate (all five dynasties) | Regional sultanates | Vijayanagara–Bahmani | Bhakti–Sufi anchors | Sur interlude | Mughal Empire | Marathas & Sikhs | 712–1707 arrange drills

Sources baked in: NCERT Themes II, Lucent / Jagran Josh medieval year lists, Anantam / Spectrum coaching chronologies, Wikipedia Timeline of Indian history (PCS-relevant entries) **Weight:** ★★★ for Sultanate–Mughal ladders and battle dates **Last verified:** September 2026 **Voice:** Full event phrases — same density style as Modern chronology. Ends at **1707** so Modern can open with Later Mughals.

M.0 Megaspine — memorise this first

Year	Event
712	Muhammad bin Qasim conquers Sind
1025–26	Mahmud of Ghazni's Somnath expedition
1191	First Battle of Tarain — Prithviraj defeats Ghori
1192	Second Battle of Tarain — Ghori defeats Prithviraj
1206	Qutbuddin Aibak founds the Delhi Sultanate
1290	Khalji dynasty begins
1320	Tughlaq dynasty begins
1398	Timur sacks Delhi
1451	Bahlul Lodi founds the Lodi dynasty
1526	First Battle of Panipat — Babur defeats Ibrahim Lodi
1540	Sher Shah Suri ousts Humayun
1556	Second Battle of Panipat — Akbar's forces defeat Hemu
1565	Battle of Talikota — Deccan Sultanates defeat Vijayanagara
1674	Coronation of Shivaji at Raigad
1699	Foundation of the Khalsa
1707	Death of Aurangzeb

M.1 Early medieval India (c. 750–1200)

Year	Event
c. 750–1000	Tripartite struggle — Palas, Gurjara-Pratiharas and Rashtrakutas fight for Kannauj
c. 8th–12th cent.	Rise of Rajput polities in north and west India; temple-building phase
788	Traditional birth year of Adi Shankaracharya in many coaching keys
c. 800	Pala emperor Dharmapala patronises Vikramashila University
814–878	Amoghavarsha I of the Rashtrakutas — Kannada literature flourishes
836–885	Mihira Bhoja of the Pratiharas — peak of Pratihara power
985–1014	Rajaraja I expands Chola power; Brihadisvara Temple phase begins
1014–1044	Rajendra I — Gangaikonda Cholapuram; naval expedition to South-East Asia
c. 1000–1027	Mahmud of Ghazni's repeated Indian campaigns
1025–26	Mahmud of Ghazni plunders the Somnath temple
1175–1206	Muhammad Ghori's campaigns lay the base of Turkish rule in north India
1191	First Battle of Tarain — Prithviraj Chauhan defeats Muhammad Ghori
1192	Second Battle of Tarain — Muhammad Ghori defeats Prithviraj Chauhan
1192–1206	Ghurid officers (Aibak, Yildiz, Qabacha) consolidate north Indian conquests
1194	Battle of Chandawar — Ghori defeats Jayachandra of Kannauj (coaching key)

M.2 Delhi Sultanate — Slave & Khalji

Year	Event
1206	Qutbuddin Aibak founds the Slave (Mamluk) dynasty; begins Quwwat-ul-Islam / Qutb complex phase
1210–36	Iltutmish consolidates the Sultanate; silver tanka and copper jital; completes Qutb Minar
1221	Chinggis Khan's pressure on the north-west frontier during Iltutmish's reign
1236–40	Reign of Razia Sultan — first woman ruler of Delhi
1266–87	Ghiyasuddin Balban — strong monarchy, spy system, frontier defence against Mongols
1290	Jalaluddin Khalji founds the Khalji dynasty
1296–1316	Alauddin Khalji — market control, standing army, conquest of Gujarat, Ranthambhor, Chittor; Malik Kafur's Deccan raids
1301	Alauddin captures Ranthambhor; end of Chauhan hold there

Year	Event
1303	Siege and capture of Chittor by Alauddin Khalji
1309–11	Malik Kafur's southern campaigns against Warangal, Dwarasamudra and Madurai
1316–20	Succession crisis after Alauddin; end of Khalji power

M.3 Delhi Sultanate — Tughlaq, Sayyid & Lodi

Year	Event
1320	Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq founds the Tughlaq dynasty
1325–51	Muhammad bin Tughlaq — capital shift Delhi–Daulatabad, token currency, Doab tax experiments
1327–34	Daulatabad as temporary capital phase
1333–34	Ibn Battuta arrives; later serves as Qazi of Delhi under Muhammad bin Tughlaq
1336	Foundation of the Vijayanagara Empire by Harihara and Bukka
1339	Shah Mir dynasty established in Kashmir
1347	Foundation of the Bahmani kingdom by Ala-ud-Din Bahman Shah
1351–88	Firoz Shah Tughlaq — canals, public works, jizya on Brahmins in many keys, new towns
1398	Timur invades and sacks Delhi — Sultanate authority collapses in the provinces
1414–51	Sayyid dynasty rules a reduced Delhi Sultanate
1451–89	Bahlul Lodi founds and consolidates the Lodi dynasty
1489–1517	Sikandar Lodi — Agra's rise as a second political centre
1517–26	Ibrahim Lodi — last Sultan of Delhi
1526	21 April — First Battle of Panipat; Babur defeats Ibrahim Lodi; Delhi Sultanate ends

M.4 Regional kingdoms & Deccan

Year	Event
1336–1565	Vijayanagara Empire — Sangama, Saluva, Tuluva and Aravidu dynasties
1347–1527	Bahmani Sultanate; later breaks into five Deccan Sultanates
1394–1479	Sharqi kingdom of Jaunpur as a major cultural centre
1407	Muzaffar Shah establishes the Sultanate of Gujarat
1418–70	Zain-ul-Abidin's notable reign in Kashmir (coaching cultural tag)

Year	Event
1459	Rao Jodha founds Jodhpur
1490 onwards	Bahmani fragmentation — Bijapur, Ahmadnagar, Golconda, Berar, Bidar
1509–29	Krishnadevaraya of Vijayanagara — peak of the empire; Ashtadiggajas
1565	Battle of Talikota (Rakshasa-Tangadi) — Deccan Sultanates defeat Vijayanagara
c. 15th–16th cent.	Independent Bengal, Malwa and Gujarat sultanates in north-west coaching maps

M.5 Mughals — Babur to Humayun & Sur

Year	Event
1526	Babur founds the Mughal Empire after Panipat; occupies Delhi and Agra
1527	Battle of Khanwa — Babur defeats Rana Sanga
1528	Battle of Chanderi
1529	Battle of Ghagra — Babur defeats Afghan confederates
1530	Death of Babur; accession of Humayun
1539	Battle of Chausa — Sher Shah defeats Humayun
1540	Battle of Kannauj / Bilgram — Humayun loses India to Sher Shah
1540–45	Sher Shah Suri's reforms — rupiya, road-sarai network, administration, land survey
1545–55	Islam Shah and weak Sur successors
1555	Humayun recovers Delhi after the Battle of Sirhind
1556	Death of Humayun; accession of Akbar; 5 November — Second Battle of Panipat — Bairam Khan defeats Hemu

M.6 Akbar to Shah Jahan

Year	Event
1556–1605	Reign of Akbar
1562	Abolition of pilgrimage tax; early Sulh-i-Kul policy signals
1564	Abolition of jizya (first time under Akbar)
1571	Foundation / shift to Fatehpur Sikri as capital phase
1575	Battle of Tukaroi — Akbar's forces defeat the Bengal Afghans

Year	Event
1576	Battle of Haldighati — Mughal forces under Man Singh fight Maharana Pratap
1579–82	Mazhar / infallibility decree phase; Din-i-Ilahi promulgated in 1582
1580s–90s	Todar Mal's revenue reforms; mansabdari expansion; conquest of Gujarat, Bengal, Kashmir
1600	English East India Company chartered (link forward to Modern)
1605	Death of Akbar; accession of Jahangir
1611	Marriage of Jahangir and Nur Jahan; Nur Jahan's political influence begins
1615–19	Sir Thomas Roe at Jahangir's court
1627	Death of Jahangir
1628–58	Reign of Shah Jahan — peak of Mughal architecture
1632–53	Construction of the Taj Mahal at Agra
1639–48	Foundation and building of Shahjahanabad (Old Delhi)

M.7 Aurangzeb, Marathas & Sikhs (to 1707)

Year	Event
1658	War of Succession; Aurangzeb defeats Dara Shikoh and becomes emperor
1659	Execution of Dara Shikoh; consolidation of Aurangzeb's accession
1665	Treaty of Purandar between Shivaji and Jai Singh I
1666	Shivaji's escape from Agra (coaching narrative tag)
1674	Coronation of Shivaji as Chhatrapati at Raigad; Ashtapradhan council
1675	Execution of Guru Tegh Bahadur at Delhi
1679	Aurangzeb reimposes jizya
1680	Death of Shivaji; accession of Sambhaji
1681 onwards	Aurangzeb's long Deccan residence and Maratha war
1686	Annexation of Bijapur
1687	Annexation of Golconda
1689	Capture and execution of Sambhaji; Rajaram continues resistance
1699	Guru Gobind Singh founds the Khalsa at Anandpur Sahib
1700	Death of Rajaram; Tarabai leads Maratha resistance

Year	Event
1707	Death of Aurangzeb at Ahmadnagar; Bahadur Shah I's accession struggle begins — opens Modern Later Mughal chronology
1708	Death of Guru Gobind Singh (edge of Medieval / Modern overlap)

M.8 Bhakti–Sufi chronological anchors (select)

Year	Event
c. 12th cent.	Early Sufi silsilas take root in north India; Chishti and Suhrawardi presence
c. 1175–1260	Traditional span associated with Moinuddin Chishti of Ajmer in many keys
c. 13th–14th cent.	Nizamuddin Auliya and Amir Khusrau at Delhi
c. 1440–1518	Kabir's period (traditional)
1469–1539	Guru Nanak — foundation of Sikhism
1486–1534	Chaitanya Mahaprabhu — Gaudiya Vaishnavism in Bengal
c. 1532–1623	Tulsidas — Ramcharitmanas
1604	Compilation of the Adi Granth under Guru Arjan
1675–1708	Guru Gobind Singh — militarisation and Khalsa